



Current Event Presentation

How disposable tech is feeding an e-waste crisis – UNEP

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Summary

Key Facts

- 54 million metric Tonnes (1.2×10^{11} lbs) of e-waste created every year
- Predicted to double by 2050
- Only **17% is recycled**
- Driven by global, unsustainable capitalistic practices



Significance

Main Purpose and Intent

- Highlight a global issue that must to be avoided and mitigated urgently
- The sheer quantity of e-waste was shocking, especially when converted to pounds

"I chose this article because it listed potential actions average people can carry into their life if they want to be more considerate about how they dispose their e-waste" – Kruthik Hulisandra



Ethical Analysis

Ethical Question:

Should companies sell more durable/long term machines reducing e-waste production at the cost of shareholder value?

- **Stakeholder Impacted:** Shareholders
- **Shareholder Interests:** Increasing profits, more innovation to maintain market position

According to Utilitarianism Ethics, we would have to compare how many people will benefit from long term machines vs how many will benefit from good shareholder price and to what degree. In this case, selling long term machines is the answer